

When it comes to research, the World Wide Web is larger than any physical library in the world. As a reader, imagine your hands lifting all those heavy books as you pore over ponderous pages, doing a painstaking research one page at a time. Then imagine a scene where your fingers are resting lightly on the keyboard as you lounge behind a monitor, scrolling the pages idly, twiddling your toes.

The Internet has thrown open the information floodgates. It has channelised many streams and rivulets of knowledge in the oceanic Web and often, finding a particular bit of information is

not much tougher than taking a dive. Though there is no foolproof way of ascertaining the source's reliability, there's no doubt about the vitality and interest that the information itself holds. And most of it is for free.

It's not easy finding a particular nugget of information among the billion pages floating on the Web, especially when search engines return thousands of vague results. It's not unlikely that you happen to be searching diligently for information on 'cattle and farming' and get flooded with pages on goat porn.

What you need are tools and tips to find relevant data without being swamped by the information overload.

With the right gear and the right links, you will be sailing the information ocean smoothly with the wind beating down your face, and the giant waves of knowledge waiting at your very command.

Tools of the trade

There is a huge difference between surfing and searching. If you're an avid Web surfer, you've probably collected hundreds of bookmarks in your Favorites folder by now. And, if you're like most people, your collection is probably an unorganised bloated mess. A browser is a powerful tool if only used for browsing. For cataloguing and cross-referencing information, and for professional level

Fishing for Information

on the Web should be as easy as sitting by the bay, watching the tide go by. But if you keep landing old boots and crumpled cans, then here's the secret to hooking up the right bait

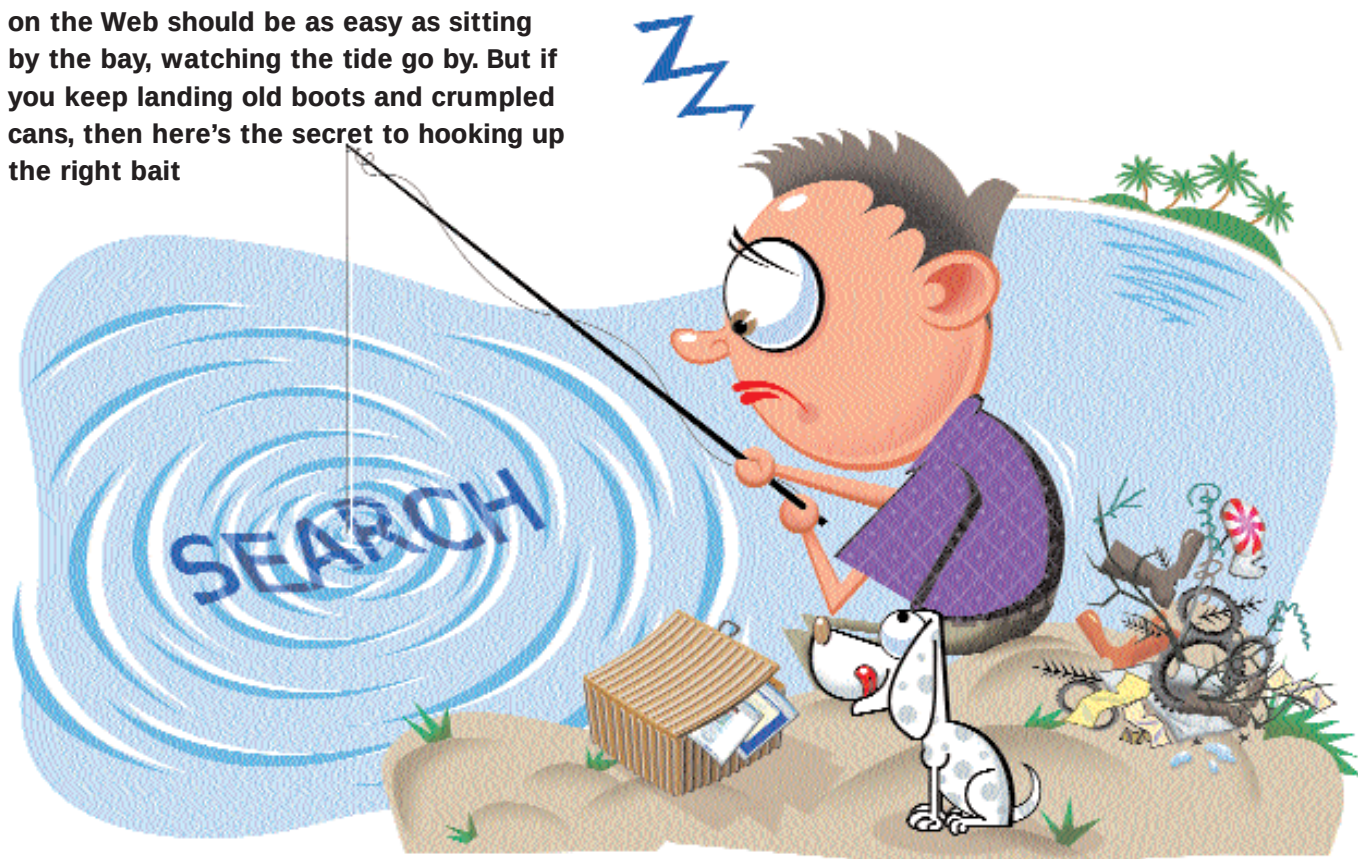


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